

Area of a Circle

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The area of a figure is the number of square units it takes to cover a figure. For a circle:

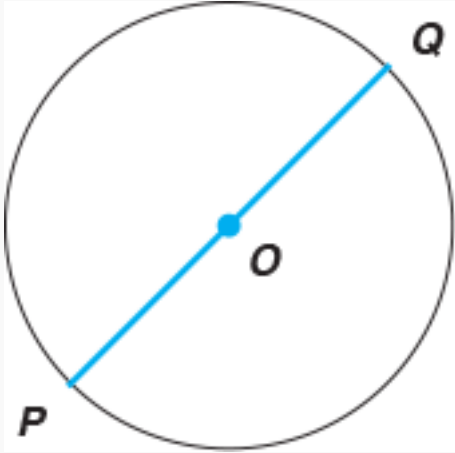
Area (*A*) of a Circle

$A = \pi r^2$, where r = radius

Example

Hide

What is the area of a circle when PQ equals 12 inches?



PQ is the diameter: $d = 12$
The radius is half the diameter: $r = 6$
Use the area formula:
 $A = \pi r^2$
 $\approx 3.14 \cdot 6^2$
 $\approx 3.14 \cdot 36$
 $\approx \mathbf{113.04 \text{ square inches}}$

Remember that area is measured in square units. Even though you can't fit squares into a circle, you can estimate how many would fit.

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Lesson 3: Circles and Complex Figures

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